Compose Intermittently Aborts with Ctrl-C

When you start your application with Compose in the default, *attached* mode—in other words, *without* the `-d` option—Compose connects to each container's `stdout`, tailing the output.

When you press `Ctrl-C`, Compose is supposed to instruct the containers to terminate by sending the main process the `SIGTERM` signal. The process should exit gracefully and then the container should terminate. When this happens correctly, the Compose output on pressing `Ctrl-C` is:

```
Killing myapp_web_1 ... done
Gracefully stopping... (press Ctrl+C again to force)
```

However, maybe 10–50 percent of the time for me, instead of the containers shutting down gracefully, we get this:

```
^CERROR: Aborting.
```

and the termination fails, leaving the containers still running. Not good.

Unfortunately, this seems to be a long-standing,[2] known[3] issue.[4] It seems to be caused by a problem in PyInstaller, an open source tool for creating executables from Python scripts, which Compose relies on.

The issue is an irritation rather than a showstopper. We can manually shut down the containers by issuing a `docker-compose stop` (or `kill`) command. However, although it seems to be an issue with a third-party dependency, it can't help but undermine our feeling of confidence in Compose itself, which is a shame.

Despite researching the issue and attempting the various, suggested fixes, I've been unable to find a workaround to prevent it. If you find yourself affected, my advice is simply to avoid starting your application in attached mode, and instead, always use *detached* mode with the `-d` option. To date, I haven't experienced the issue with that.

Quick Recap

No software is perfect, but it's unfortunate when your experience with using a tool is diminished due to bugs. I have to confess: it pained me to write this chapter. I wanted your experience of using Docker to be uniformly positive.

2. https://github.com/docker/compose/issues/2904
3. https://github.com/docker/compose/issues/3317
4. https://github.com/docker/compose/issues/3347